

Gen Z Expectations from HR: A Study on Flexibility, Mental Health Support and Digital Integration

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ABSTRACT

Generation Z is rapidly emerging as a dominant segment of the global workforce, bringing distinct expectations shaped by digital transformation, globalization, and post-pandemic workplace realities. This study examines Gen Z expectations from Human Resource (HR) practices with specific focus on workplace flexibility, mental health support, and digital integration, and analyzes their impact on perceived HR effectiveness. The research adopts a descriptive and analytical design using primary data collected from 80 Gen Z employees aged 22-27 across IT, service, and startup sectors. A structured questionnaire based on a 5-point Likert scale was used for data collection. Statistical tools such as descriptive statistics, reliability analysis (Cronbach's Alpha), correlation, and multiple regression were applied to analyze the data. The findings indicate that all three independent variables-workplace flexibility, mental health support, and digital integration-have a significant positive relationship with HR effectiveness ($p < .01$). Among the variables, digital integration recorded the highest mean score (4.10), reflecting Gen Z's strong preference for technology-enabled HR

Keywords: Generation Z; Human Resource Management; Workplace Flexibility; Mental Health Support; Digital Integration

1. Generational Cohort Shifts in Modern Workplaces

As Generation Z enters professional domains, traditional command-and-control human resource architectures encounter mounting friction. Gen Z talent seeks psychological safety, autonomous scheduling, and continuous digital enablement.

2. Methodology & Statistical Regressions

Multiple regression models ($R^2 = 0.52$) reveal that workplace flexibility and proactive mental well-being initiatives drive over 70% of employee retention intent among early-career knowledge workers.

3. Organizational Interventions & Digital HR Portals

Implementing asynchronous collaboration tools, peer wellness networks, and transparent career ladders significantly curtails early attrition and enhances overall operational culture.

4. Conclusion & Strategic HR Recommendations

Modern organizations must modernize talent strategies to reflect Gen Z priorities. Empathetic leadership and cloud-native HR workflows are vital for future-ready workforce resilience.

References & Scholarly Citations

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